

ALESSIA PAPINI

Department of Economics, European University Institute
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EDUCATION

- 2025– Ph.D. in Economics, European University Institute
 Supervisors: Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Alexander Ludwig
- 2024–25 Master of Research in Economics, European University Institute
- 2021–23 M.Sc. in Economic and Social Sciences, Università Bocconi
 Supervisor: Prof. Tommaso Monacelli Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude
- 2018–21 B.A. in Economics, Università degli Studi di Firenze Final Grade: 110/110 cum Laude

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Expectation Formation, Fiscal and Monetary Policy

WORK IN PROGRESS

“Fiscal Policy and Household Over-Optimism”

This paper studies whether fiscal policy transmits to the economy through a sentiment channel. The post-pandemic European fiscal regime shift moved household credit-access beliefs across the euro area. I study Italy, where the Draghi credibility event of February 2021 provides a sharp, datable domestic amplification of the common European shock. Using the ECB Consumer Expectations Survey, I construct individual-level credit-access forecast errors and estimate their response with the Forecasted Average Treatment estimator, designed for settings of universal treatment. I document systematic and persistent over-optimism: forecast errors increase by up to 7.8 percent of the survey scale, peaking several months after the announcement before gradually declining. Finally, I show that over-optimistic beliefs are associated with active credit-seeking behavior: a one-unit increase in the forecast error is associated with a 0.78 percentage-point higher probability of applying for credit in the subsequent quarter.

PUBLICATIONS

Guerini, C., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “Literacy and Financial Education: Private Providers, Public Certification and Political Preferences.” *Italian Economic Journal*, 2024.
[doi:10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/s40797-024-00287-1)

Borghi, E., Masciandaro, D. & Papini, A. “European Politicians and Financial Literacy Activism: Does Financial (In)Stability Matter?” *Economics Letters*, 2024.
[doi:10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.econlet.2024.111981)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

- 2025– Research Assistant to Profs. Giancarlo Corsetti and Saverio Simonelli, European University Institute
- 2023–24 Research Assistant to Profs. Donato Masciandaro, Elisa Borghi and Magda Bianco (Bank of Italy), Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi
- 2022–23 Research Assistant to Prof. Tommaso Monacelli, Università Bocconi
- Feb–Apr 2023 Research Intern in Monetary Policy, Baffi-Carefin Centre, Università Bocconi

GRANTS, FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

- 2025 Bank of Italy Grant for Female Economists

2024	Italian Grant for Master of Research Students, European University Institute
2022	Premio di Laurea Lorenzo Bruni, Università degli Studi di Firenze — Best Undergraduate in Economics, A.Y. 2020/21
2022	Premio America Giovani, UNAI — Full Tuition Waiver. Top 1,000 Italian graduates of A.Y. 2020/21

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fall 2025	Teaching Assistant, <i>Macroeconomics I</i> (PhD), European University Institute <i>Prof. Alexander Ludwig</i>
2024–25	Teaching Assistant, <i>International Economics</i> and <i>Microeconomics</i> , Politecnico di Milano <i>Profs. Giulia Felice and Lucia Tajoli</i>
Feb–Jun 2022	Tutor, TOP Project, Fondazione CIAI — Bocconi University / Harvard University

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, R, L^AT_EX, Python, Gretl, MATLAB, QGIS

Languages: Italian (native), English (C1), French (B1)